

Getting Started with Module 2: Epidemics & SIR Modeling

This guide will help you and your partner set up a shared repository where you can collaborate on course materials throughout the module.

Overview

- **Partner A** forks the course repo and adds Partner B as a collaborator
 - **Partner B** accepts the invitation and clones the shared repo
 - **Both partners** can pull new course materials each week and collaborate on assignments
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Prerequisites

- ✓ GitHub account
 - ✓ GitHub Desktop installed ([Download here](#))
 - ✓ A partner assigned for the module
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Part 1: Partner A - Fork and Share

Step 1: Fork the Repository

1. Go to: <https://github.com/smgroves/Module-2-Epidemics-SIR-Modeling>
2. Click the **"Fork"** button (upper-right corner)
3. Your fork will be at: `https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/Module-2-Epidemics-SIR-Modeling`

☞ You should see "forked from smgroves/Module-2-Epidemics-SIR-Modeling" at the top

Step 2: Add Partner B as Collaborator

1. On your fork's page, click **"Settings"** tab
2. Click **"Collaborators"** in left sidebar
3. Click **"Add people"**
4. Enter Partner B's GitHub username
5. Click **"Add [username] to this repository"**

Partner B will receive an email invitation!

Step 3: Clone to Your Computer

1. On your fork's page, click green **"Code"** button
2. Click **"Open with GitHub Desktop"**
3. Choose where to save it (e.g., `Documents/Classes`)
4. Click **"Clone"**
5. When asked "How are you planning to use this fork?":
 - Select **"For my own purposes"**
 - Click **"Continue"**

☞ You should see the repo in GitHub Desktop's repository list

Step 4: Verify Upstream (Get Course Updates)

1. In GitHub Desktop, go to: **Repository → Repository Settings** (or Preferences on Windows)
2. Click **"Remote"** tab
3. You should see **upstream** already listed:

- **origin:** Your fork
- **upstream:** `https://github.com/smgroves/Module-2-Epidemics-SIR-Modeling.git`

☒ Since you selected "For my own purposes," upstream should automatically be set up!

Part 2: Partner B - Join the Shared Repo

Step 1: Accept Invitation

1. Check your email for GitHub invitation
2. Click the link and **"Accept invitation"**

☒ You should now see the repository with full access

Step 2: Clone the Shared Repository

1. Go to Partner A's fork: `https://github.com/PARTNER-A-USERNAME/Module-2-Epidemics-SIR-Modeling`
2. Click green **"Code"** button
3. Click **"Open with GitHub Desktop"**
4. Choose where to save it
5. Click **"Clone"**

☒ Repo appears in GitHub Desktop

Step 3: Add Upstream Remote

Since GitHub Desktop doesn't have a button to add remotes, we'll use a quick Terminal command:

1. In GitHub Desktop: **Repository → Open in Terminal** (Mac) or **Open in Command Prompt** (Windows)
2. Type this command and press Enter:

```
git remote add upstream https://github.com/smgroves/Module-2-Epidemics-SIR-Modeling.git
```

3. Close the Terminal/Command Prompt
4. In GitHub Desktop: **Repository → Repository Settings → Remote** tab

☒ You should now see both origin and upstream listed

Part 3: Getting New Course Materials (Either Partner)

When instructor announces new materials:

1. **Open GitHub Desktop**, select your repo
2. Make sure **"Current Branch"** shows "main" at the top
3. Go to menu: **Branch → Merge into Current Branch...**
4. In the window that opens, look for the **"upstream/main"** branch in the list
 - You may need to scroll down to find it
 - It will be under a section labeled "Other branches"
5. **Click on "upstream/main"** to select it
6. Click the blue **"Merge upstream/main into main"** button at the bottom
7. Click **"Push origin"** (button in top right) to share with your partner
8. **Tell your partner** to pull!

When your partner already pulled updates:

1. Click **"Fetch origin"** (button in top right)
2. If updates available, button changes to **"Pull origin"** - click it

🔗 Both partners now have latest materials!

Part 4: Collaborating on Your Work

Saving Your Changes:

1. Make edits to files
2. Open GitHub Desktop (changes appear automatically)
3. Review changes in left panel
4. Write commit message: "Added Week 3 notes - [Your Name]"
5. Click **"Commit to main"**
6. Click **"Push origin"**
7. Tell your partner!

Getting Your Partner's Changes:

1. Click **"Fetch origin"**
2. If updates available, click **"Pull origin"**

🔗 You now have your partner's work!

Collaboration Tips

- 🔗 **Pull before starting work** - Get your partner's latest changes first
 - 🔗 **Push when done** - Share your work right away
 - 🔗 **Include your name in commits** - "Fixed bug - Sarah"
 - 🔗 **Work on different files** - Avoid conflicts when possible
 - 🔗 **Communicate** - Tell your partner when you push
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Troubleshooting

Merge Conflict

When: You both edited the same part of a file

Fix: 1. GitHub Desktop shows files with ⚠️ 2. Click file → "Open in [Your Editor]" 3. Find conflict markers: `` <<<<<< HEAD Your changes

Partner's changes

| | | | | | | origin/main

4. Edit to keep what you want, delete markers
5. Save file
6. In GitHub Desktop: **"Continue merge"**
7. Click **"Commit merge"** → **"Push origin"**

Can't Push

When: "Pull before push" message appears

Fix:

1. Click **"Pull origin"** first
2. Resolve conflicts if any
3. Then push

Weekly Routine

Start of week:

1. One partner: Merge from upstream/main → Push
2. Other partner: Pull from origin
3. Both synced with new course materials!

During week:

1. Pull from origin before working
2. Make changes, commit often
3. Push to origin when done
4. Tell partner you pushed

Visual Workflow

Instructor's Repo (upstream) ↓ [Merge weekly] ↓ Partner A's Fork (origin) ← Both partners push/pull here ↙ ↘ Partner A Partner B (Computer) (Computer)

...

Quick Reference

First-Time Setup

Partner A: Fork → Add Partner B → Clone → Verify upstream

Partner B: Accept invite → Clone → Add upstream

Get New Materials

1. Check Current Branch = "main"
2. Branch → Merge into Current Branch...
3. Click "upstream/main" in the list
4. Click "Merge upstream/main into main"
5. Push origin → Tell partner

Save & Share Work

Commit → Push origin → Tell partner

Get Partner's Work

Fetch origin → Pull origin

You're all set! 🎉

Questions? Post in Canvas or come to office hours with screenshots of any errors.

